Jake Walder

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Game Designer with a **decade of experience** shipping over **15 titles** across **PC**, **console** and **mobile**, dedicated to building **innovative** and **engaging** gaming experiences. **Creative thinker** and **problem-solver** who is always coming up with **new ideas** and **solutions**. Seeking an **exciting** and **unique** project to get stuck into.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Game Designer — *Tripledot Studios, London* September 2022 - February 2026

- **Core Responsibilities:** Owned the player experience and all gameplay content for *Woodoku* and *Woodoku Blast*, reporting directly to the CPO and Level Design Director. Designed and directed features, created detailed design documents and wireframes, designed and curated levels and puzzles, and used data and experience to optimise content, devise future roadmaps and execute extensive A/B testing.
- **Leadership & Mentorship:** Led a 3-person design team and successfully mentored one Junior to Mid-level to Senior, and another from Junior to Mid-level. Completed an 8 module management programme.
- **Team Collaboration:** Directed the production of features and mechanics, working alongside Product, Analysts, Development, Art and QA to create the best possible features from pre-production to post-release. Organised playtests and brainstorming, and consulted on new game projects within the studio.
- **Data & Analytics:** Utilised analysis skills and ran intensive experiments to deeply understand player behaviour, evaluating the impact of design iterations to guide feature improvements and future roadmaps.

Woodoku — 150M+ Downloads

- Owned all gameplay elements; designed systems, levels and features. Created a level extension that increased engagement by 20% and ARPDAU by 15%. Engineered new shape-generation algorithms that boosted retention by 5%, designed a bespoke level editor, and optimised 152 levels weekly for LiveOps.

Woodoku Blast — 20M+ Downloads

- Owned the design and production of all gameplay elements, systems and UX design, haptics and audio. Created features that drove a 10% increase in ARPDAU, and devised extensive A/B testing and data-driven level design iterations to deeply understand player behaviour and boost retention by 5%.

Design Consultant, Composer — *Meathook, Indie Game* February 2025 - July 2026

- Executed a full game audit and consulted on the game's design, directly improving core mechanics and systems, tutorial and progression flow, level design and UI/UX design.
- Co-wrote, produced, mixed and mastered the soundtrack for the indie title *Meathook* under the alias HYPNO.

Game Designer — *Playtika, London* June 2020 - June 2022

- Reporting directly to the Product Lead as the sole game designer, creating design documentation and providing the design and player perspective for *BRIX Blast Friends* and *BRIX Blast Rivals*.
- Designed and curated dozens of features, managing their development from the initial idea to final implementation by writing detailed specifications and overseeing the work of the developers and artists.
- Solely responsible for level design for both titles, utilising data analysis to inform level design iterations that optimised and improved retention, engagement and monetisation.

QA Lead & Level Designer — *Massive Monster, Southampton* October 2015 - August 2016

> ***'Your dedication, attitude and all round personality have made you a joy to work with.'* – Jay Armstrong, Co-Founder**

- Designed and curated over 50% of the levels and designed various game objects and mechanics for *The Adventure Pals*, and contributed to the level design effort for *Never Give Up*.
- Responsible for all QA and level curation for both titles, ensuring high level quality and reliable game stability.

QA Tester — *Excalibur Publishing, Banbury* October 2015 - August 2016

- Responsible for QA of over 10 Steam titles, including *Jalopy* and *Shoppe Keep*; which required a strong grasp of gameplay mechanics to effectively identify, analyse and document bugs.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Walder Games — *Independent Game Developer* February 2026 - Present

- Designed, developed and released a mobile game called *Penguin Slide* in Unity for Android and Web. Programmed in Unity and created all art, music, SFX and levels, utilising AI tools to accelerate engineering.

HYPNO — Electronic Music Duo 2020 - Present

- Co-wrote, produced and mixed 3 singles released across all major music platforms; created custom single artwork using Photoshop.

EDUCATION

Bournemouth University — *BSc Games Programming (2:1)* September 2016 - June 2019

- Completed a research dissertation involving a reaction-time-based mobile game in Unity (75%) and developed core skills through the following modules: Gameplay, Physics, UI, Core Loops and AI.

Peter Symonds College — *Maths, Physics & Computing A-Levels* September 2013 - June 2015

SKILLS

- **Gameplay Design**, **Level Design**, **Systems Design**, UI/UX, LiveOps, Balancing & Economy, Wireframing, QA Systems.
- **Unity**, **Photoshop**, Looker, Figma, Miro, VSCode, Aseprite, **Excel/Sheets**, GitHub, JIRA, Confluence, Antigravity, Blender.
- Experienced with **C#**, **C++** and **SQL** and utilising **AI tools** to accelerate development and create rapid prototypes.

INTERESTS

- **Travelling:** Recently took an intentional career break to **travel all over Southeast Asia** for 6 months.
- **Music:** Guitarist, **self-taught music producer** currently **writing and producing 2 albums**. Previously recorded with a **Grammy-winning producer**, aired by **BBC Introducing** and **performed** at a **music festival**.
- **Games:** Constantly playing and staying **up to date** with the **console, PC and mobile markets**.
- **Hardware & Audio:** Utilise **self-taught electronics knowledge** to modify guitars and create guitar pedals.

FAVOURITE GAMES

Assassin's Creed, Pokemon, Baldur's Gate 3, Skyrim, CS:GO, Minecraft, The Witcher 3, Halo, Stardew Valley, Zelda.